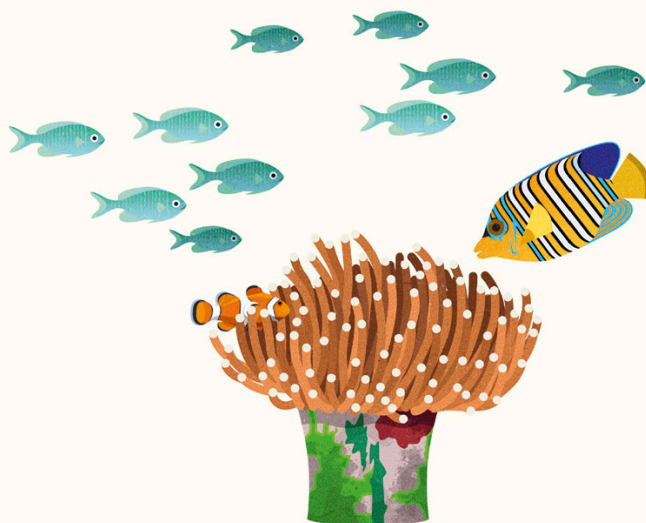


Coral



This colourful underwater flower is not what it seems. The blue petals of this plant are actually parts of a tiny animal called a coral polyp (pol-ip). Each soft-bodied polyp builds a stony skeleton around itself. Slowly, over many years, the skeletons grow and join up, creating a reef. At night, the reef comes alive as the polyps unfurl their stinging tentacles to catch microscopic animals and pass them to their central mouth.

Coral reefs are a riot of colour as they are home to more fish than any other habitat in the ocean. Starfish, sponges, octopuses, eels, and crabs are just some of the many animals you'll find there.

***Australia's Great Barrier Reef is so big
you can see it from space.***